

Question 42 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Describe the major steps involved in designing a training program.

Introduction

Design is Stage 2 of the training cycle — planning the training. A training plan describes the key decisions, tasks and resources needed. The notes even show a simple matrix: training goal, learning objectives, learning methods/activities, facilities and resource persons, and budget.

Design converts TNA into a blueprint that a trainer can deliver. If TNA was skipped, these steps only decorate the wrong building. Design is more than a timetable of lectures; it is a plan for learning and for transfer to the job.

Detailed points

- 1. Step 1 — Confirm needs, trainees and readiness.** Re-check TNA. Confirm who will attend and whether they are ready: basic literacy, language, prior skill, motivation. Unready trainees fail even a beautiful design. Also confirm that training is still the right solution.
- 2. Step 2 — Set training goals and learning objectives.** The goal is the overall capability (e.g., handle complaints to SOP). Learning objectives are specific and observable: ‘By the end, the trainee will be able to log a complaint correctly in the software in five minutes.’ Objectives drive content, method and tests. Vague aims (‘appreciate quality’) produce vague courses.
- 3. Step 3 — Select content and sequence.** What topics, in what order? Usually concept then demonstration then practice then feedback. Content must match tasks from TNA, not the trainer’s favourite stories. Cut everything that does not serve an objective.
- 4. Step 4 — Choose methods and activities.** Lectures, workshops, cases, role play, simulation, on-the-job practice, e-learning, team exercises — matched to the type of objective. Skill needs practice; knowledge can use explanation and quiz; attitude needs discussion and modelling. The notes ask: on-the-job or off-the-job? Internal or outsourced? Inside or off-site?
- 5. Step 5 — Plan facilities, trainers, materials and budget.** Venue, audio-visual, handouts, meals, travel, choice of resource persons, and costs that accounts will accept. Poor admin later looks like poor training. Budget honesty is part of design, not an afterthought.
- 6. Step 6 — Design transfer of training.** Learning dies if the workplace is ignored. Design pre-briefing of bosses, action plans, post-training projects, job aids, and time to practise on the job. Transfer is a design step, not a hope.
- 7. Step 7 — Build evaluation into the plan.** Decide now: reaction form, learning test, behaviour check after 30–60 days, result measure versus TNA baseline. If you wait until after the valedictory function, evaluation will be only a smile sheet.
- 8. Step 8 — Review the whole plan for feasibility and equity.** Can production release people? Are women and distant-branch staff included? Is batch size small enough for practice? A design that looks perfect on paper but cannot be attended is not a design; it is a wish.

Conclusion. Describe design as a sequence: confirm TNA and readiness; write goals and objectives; choose content, methods, place and provider; plan facilities and budget; design transfer; build evaluation; check feasibility and fairness. Use the notes’ matrix. Design is a plan for learning and job use, not a list of speech titles.